Practical 2: Build a Grouped RetailPulse Sales List Report

Related topic: Create List Reports

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Objective

Construct a list report, group it meaningfully, format its columns, and add a summarising footer.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, RetailPulse Sales package, the report saved in Practical 1 (optional starting point).

Step-by-Step Procedure

1. Create a new **List** report against the RetailPulse Sales package.

2. Add **Region, Store Name, Product Category, Quantity** and **Sales Amount** as columns.

3. Select the Region column, click **Group/Ungroup**; then select Store Name and click **Group/Ungroup**.

Order matters: Region first, then Store Name, giving a two-level hierarchy with duplicates collapsed.

4. Select Sales Amount > **Data Format** > Currency (2 decimals); select Quantity and Sales Amount, set **Horizontal alignment: Right**.

5. Select Sales Amount, click **Summarize > Total** so a footer total appears under each group; set Quantity to Total as well.

Cognos adds a list footer per Store Name group and an overall footer (Grand Total).

6. Insert a **Text Item** and a **Date** item (Toolbox) into the **Page Header**: title and today's run date. Run and save as "RetailPulse - Grouped Sales Report".

Sample Solution (Output)

RetailPulse - Grouped Sales Report Run date: 08 October 2026

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
North	North Plaza	Electronics	26	$6,017.57
		Apparel	168	$7,630.28
		Home & Kitchen	65	$4,955.83
		Total North Plaza	**259**	**$18,603.68**
	North Square	Electronics	22	$5,205.30
		Apparel	152	$6,663.97
		Home & Kitchen	94	$7,124.84
		Total North Square	**268**	**$18,994.11**
South	South Harbor	Electronics	26	$6,418.43
		Apparel	148	$6,929.02
		Home & Kitchen	95	$7,915.72
		Total South Harbor	**269**	**$21,263.17**
	South Gardens	Electronics	34	$8,327.48
		Apparel	159	$7,015.40

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
		Home & Kitchen	54	$4,409.53
		Total South Gardens	**247**	**$19,752.41**
East	East Gate	Electronics	27	$6,417.69
		Apparel	170	$7,793.17
		Home & Kitchen	86	$6,642.85
		Total East Gate	**283**	**$20,853.71**
	East Market	Electronics	33	$7,757.60
		Apparel	161	$6,895.98
		Home & Kitchen	91	$7,121.11
		Total East Market	**285**	**$21,774.69**
West	West End	Electronics	30	$7,489.90
		Apparel	130	$5,804.39
		Home & Kitchen	97	$8,105.53
		Total West End	**257**	**$21,399.82**
	West Park	Electronics	32	$7,219.63
		Apparel	142	$6,738.69
		Home & Kitchen	93	$7,650.26
		Total West Park	**267**	**$21,608.58**
		Grand Total	**2,135**	**$164,250.17**

Figure 2.1: Region bands containing nested Store Name bands, with a Total under each store and an overall Grand Total.

What a Correct Result Looks Like

The report groups into Region bands containing nested Store Name bands; Sales Amount displays with currency formatting and a correctly summed total beneath each Store Name group; the page header shows the title and today's date on every page.

Expected Outcome

Rows are grouped by Region and Store Name with duplicates collapsed; Sales Amount is formatted and right-aligned; group totals sum correctly; the page header appears on every page.

Verification Checklist

Check	Status
Two-level grouping Region > Store Name	Verified
Sales Amount currency formatted, numeric columns right-aligned	Verified
Store totals roll up to Grand Total $164,250.17	Verified
Page header with title and run date on every page	Verified

Note on screens and data: Figures in this file are illustrative renderings of how each Cognos Analytics output looks, built from a sample RetailPulse data set (8 stores, 3 product categories, Jul-Oct 2026). All totals reconcile across Practicals 1-5. Replace them with screenshots from your own Cognos session before submission if your lab requires live captures.